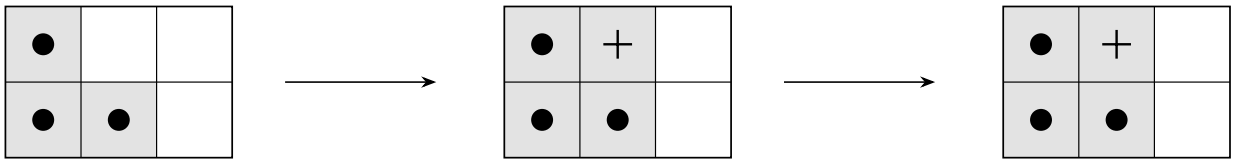
Week 98 / Growing from a few seeds / Grades 2–3

Seeds are the squares filled at the start. Put counters on them. Add a counter to an empty square when at least two squares sharing its sides are filled. Your partner points to two filled neighbors before each addition. Counters stay put. Stop when no more can be added. Diagonal touches do not count. There are no squares outside the board.

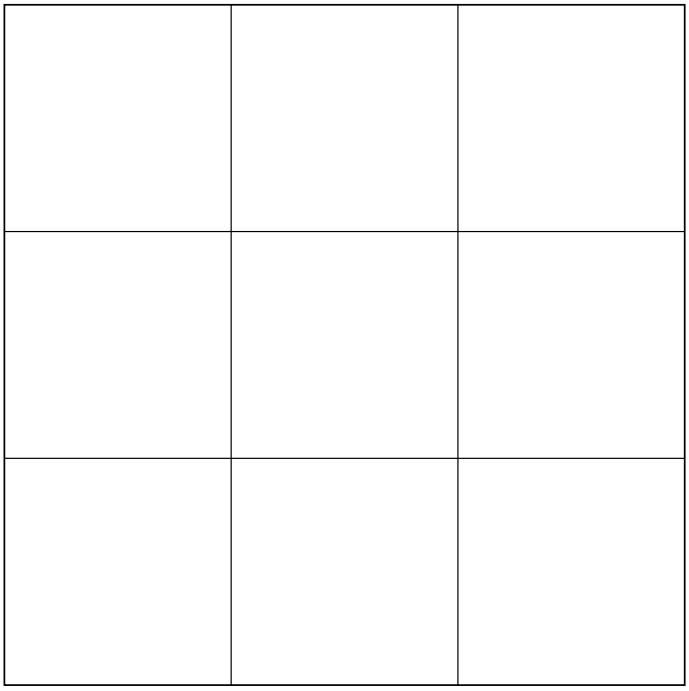
Mark seeds with • and added squares with $+$.



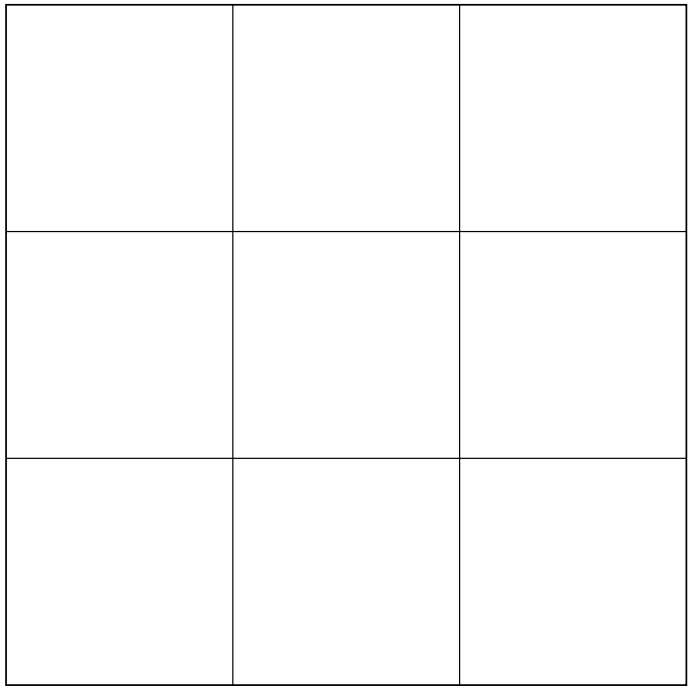
Start | One square added | Stopped

Problem 3: Choose exactly three seeds on each board. Make the finishes have 3, 4, 6 and 9 filled squares. Can three seeds finish with any other number of filled squares?

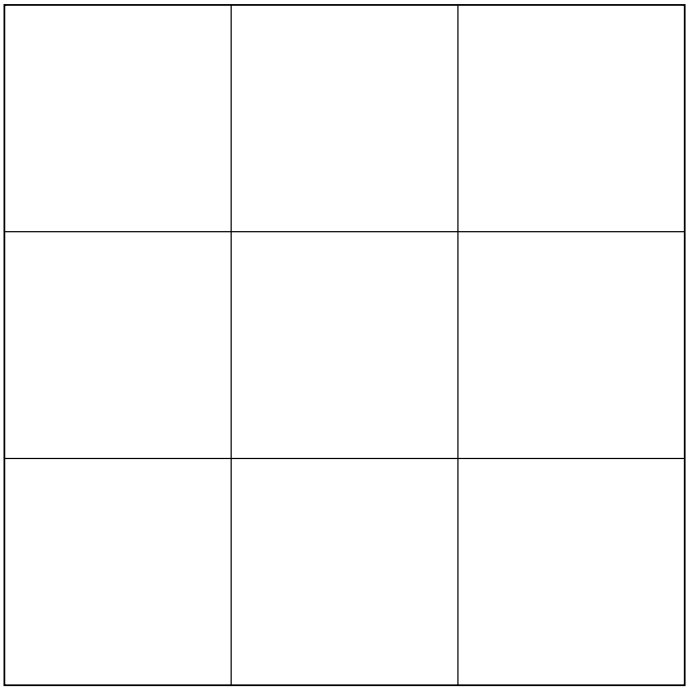
3 filled squares



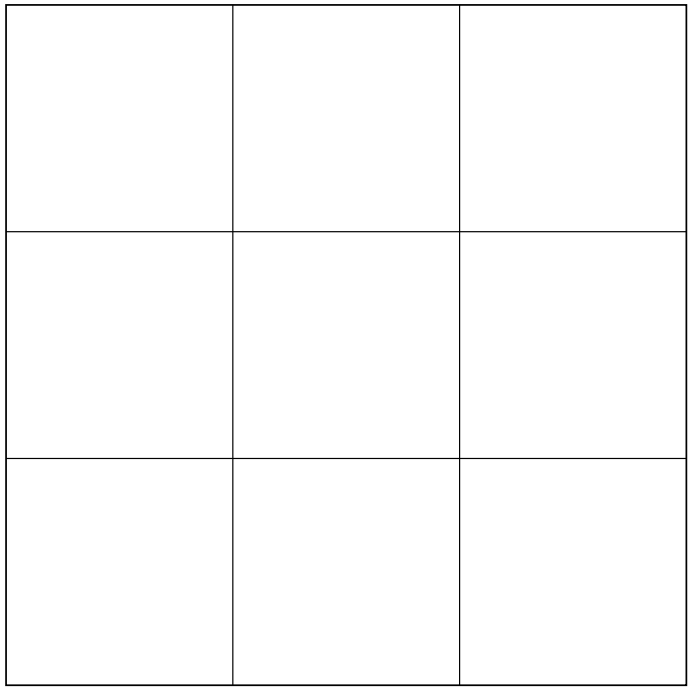
4 filled squares



6 filled squares



9 filled squares



Problem 5: Grow the four-seed start. Then test all four ways to leave out one seed and start again. Is every seed needed? Is four the fewest seeds that can fill the board?

